Web Cut Pro: Apple Final Cut Pro Tutorial Companion Guide

Official Cross-Platform Workflow & Feature Translation Reference

> **How to use this guide:** When you watch any YouTube, Lynda, or Masterclass video tutorial for Apple Final Cut Pro (FCP), use this companion cheat sheet to instantly translate what the tutorial instructor is clicking or teaching into the exact equivalent workflow in **Web Cut Pro**.

1. Quick "Rosetta Stone" Translation Table

Use this table to translate verbal instructions and UI actions from Final Cut Pro videos directly to Web Cut Pro:

When the FCP Tutorial Video Says...	What It Means	In Web Cut Pro, Do This:
"Import media into Event / Library"	Loading raw video, audio, or images into the project catalog.	Click `+ Import Media` in the top-left Clips browser, or drag-and-drop any media file directly into the browser window. Media is saved inside your private **Origin Private File System (OPFS)** sandbox.
"Append to Primary Storyline (E)"	Placing a clip sequentially at the tail of your magnetic spine.	Tap `+` on any thumbnail in the Clips browser or drag the clip onto the main magnetic spine.
"Connect Clip / B-Roll (Q)"	Attaching a cutaway, b-roll, or graphics above the primary storyline.	Hover over any media item in the clips drawer and click `Connect (Q)` or drag it into an upper lane. Connected clips stay anchored to their parent moment.
"Blade Tool (B)" or "Blade at Playhead (⌘B)"	Slicing the active clip at the current playhead timecode.	Press `B` or `⌘B` (or click the **Blade** button on the timeline toolbar). A razor-clean non-destructive cut is made immediately.
"Ripple Delete (Delete / ⌫)"	Removing a clip and having the rest of the timeline snap forward.	Select the clip and press `Delete` or `Backspace`. Web Cut Pro's **Magnetic Engine** automatically collapses the gap.
"Insert Gap Clip (⌥W)"	Adding blank spacing or timed breathing room between clips.	Press `⌥ + W` or click `Gap` on the timeline toolbar. A standard neutral spacer clip is inserted.
"Magnetic Snapping (N)"	Toggling auto-snapping of playheads, edits, and markers.	Press `N` (or toggle the magnetic horseshoe icon).
"Skimmer (S)"	Previewing footage under the mouse cursor before moving the playhead.	Press `S` (or toggle the orange vertical skimmer line in the timeline).
"Inspector Panel (⌘4)"	Accessing clip properties, transform, audio, and color.	Click any clip on your timeline — the right-side **Inspector** opens with **Video**, **Color**, and **Audio** tabs.
"3-Way Color Wheels (⌘6)"	Color grading Shadows, Midtones, Highlights, and Master.	Select the clip, go to the Inspector's **Color** tab, and select **Color Wheels**. Drag the Lift, Gamma, and Gain pucks.
"Smart Conform (Auto-Reframe to 9:16)"	Reframing landscape 16:9 video into vertical TikTok/Reels format.	Tap the `Reframe` button on the top menu bar to change project aspect ratio, or check **Auto Reframe** under the clip's Video inspector.
"Parametric EQ & Voice Isolation"	Cleaning background noise and boosting dialogue warmth.	Go to the Inspector's **Audio** tab. Toggle **Voice Isolation** or sculpt audio using the **10-Band Parametric Equalizer** and Brickwall Limiter.

When the FCP Tutorial Video Says...	What It Means	In Web Cut Pro, Do This:
"Share > Master File (⌘E)"	Exporting the completed video for YouTube, Vimeo, or client delivery.	Click the blue `Share` button in the top right. Choose **Apple ProRes 422**, **H.264 MP4**, or **High Frame Rate WebM**.
"Export XML (.fcpxml)"	Handing off the timeline to DaVinci Resolve or desktop Final Cut Pro.	Click `•••` in the top bar and select **Export FCPXML...**. Downloads a validated **FCPXML 1.11** document.

2. Core Differences: Desktop Final Cut Pro vs. Web Cut Pro

While Web Cut Pro faithfully mimics Final Cut Pro's workflow, editing directly inside modern web browsers introduces three key advantages and architectural differences:

Storage & Privacy: OPFS Sandbox vs. Finder Bundles

- **Desktop Final Cut Pro:** Stores assets in proprietary `.fcpbundle` packages on your local hard drive or external RAID drives.
- **Web Cut Pro:** Uses your browser's ultra-fast **Origin Private File System (OPFS)**. No external server uploads occur; your video and audio remain 100% private, sandboxed locally inside your browser storage.

Screen Layout: Adaptive Apple UI for Mobile & Tablet

- **Desktop & Laptop Displays (≥ 1024px):** Exactly replicates FCP's standard 3-pane layout:
  - **Top Left:** Media Browser (Clips & B-Roll)
  - **Center:** Cinema Viewer (16:9 / 9:16 / 1:1 playback with SMPTE timecode)
  - **Top Right:** Multi-tab Inspector (Video, Color, Audio)
  - **Bottom:** Magnetic Timeline with connected b-roll lanes & audio waveforms
- **Mobile & iPad Mode (< 1024px):** Uses an Apple-style **Segmented Workspace Bar** at the bottom to toggle smoothly between `Timeline`, `Media`, `Inspector`, and `Effects` without cluttering smaller touchscreen viewports.

Video Rendering & Shaders

- **Desktop Final Cut Pro:** Relies on macOS Apple Metal GPU APIs.
- **Web Cut Pro:** Utilizes **WebGL 2.0 / WebGPU shaders** and browser **WebCodecs**, allowing real-time color grading, optical flow speed ramps, Ken Burns motion, and glitch/dissolve transitions directly in the browser tab with zero lag.

3. Essential Keyboard Shortcuts Reference

All classic Final Cut Pro editing hotkeys work identically in Web Cut Pro:

Shortcut	Action	Description
`Space`	Play / Pause	Starts or pauses playback at current playhead position.
`J` – `K` – `L`	Reverse / Stop / Shuttle Forward	Industry standard shuttle keys (tap `L` repeatedly for 2x, 4x speed).
`B` or `⌘B`	Blade Cut	Slices active clip non-destructively at current playhead.
`Delete` / `Backspace`	Ripple Delete	Removes selected clip; magnetic timeline snaps shut automatically.
`E`	Append to Spine	Places clip at the end of the primary magnetic storyline.

Shortcut	Action	Description
`Q`	Connect B-Roll	Anchors clip above the primary storyline at the playhead.
`⌥ + W`	Insert Gap Clip	Inserts standard blank spacer clip for pacing.
`N`	Snapping Toggle	Toggles magnetic alignment to edit points and markers.
`S`	Skimmer Toggle	Toggles hover scrubbing across clips and timeline.
`⌘ + Z`	Undo	Reverts previous editing action.
`⇧ + ⌘ + Z`	Redo	Reapplies reverted editing action.
`⌘ + E`	Share / Export	Opens the Master Export dialog.
`?`	Open Companion Guide	Opens the in-app Tutorial Companion Guide modal.

4. Recommended Step-by-Step Learning Flow

If you are watching a beginner Final Cut Pro tutorial on YouTube, follow these sequential steps in Web Cut Pro:

1. **Lesson 1: Organizing Footage & Ingesting** — In the tutorial, they import media into an Event. In Web Cut Pro, click `+ Import Media` or drag your video files directly into the window.
2. **Lesson 2: Rough Cut Assembly** — Follow the instructor's cutting points. Press `Space` to play, `⌘B` to cut, and `Delete` to remove unwanted takes. Notice how the magnetic timeline keeps your story in sync.
3. **Lesson 3: Adding B-Roll & Titles** — When the tutorial says to connect cutaways above the primary storyline, hover over your b-roll clips and click `Connect (Q)`.
4. **Lesson 4: Color Grading & Look Development** — Click your clip, switch the Inspector to **Color**, and select **Color Wheels**. Follow the instructor's advice on balancing shadows (Lift), skin tones (Gamma), and skies (Gain).
5. **Lesson 5: Audio Polishing** — Switch the Inspector to **Audio**, turn on **Voice Isolation** for noisy speech, and shape your soundtrack using the 10-band equalizer.
6. **Lesson 6: Exporting or XML Roundtrip** — Hit `Share` to download your finalized 4K or 1080p video, or click `••• > Export FCPXML` if you wish to finish in desktop Final Cut Pro or DaVinci Resolve.